

FIVE ASPECTS OF MAN

CHAPTER 1

LORD OF THE EARTH — CREATED

Man as Representative of God

THE QUESTION

Who is man, and what is he doing here?

THE ANSWER

Man was created in God's image to rule the earth for Him.

KEY PASSAGE GENESIS 1:26

"Then God said, 'Let Us make man in Our image, according to Our likeness ...'" (NKJV)

CORE DEFINITION

God created man in His image to rule and subdue the earth as God's viceroy and as the head of mankind.

1 WHAT IS MAN? THE IMAGE OF GOD

- God is the original Person; man is His image—a created representation or replica.
- Man's characteristics are patterned after God's characteristics.
- The image belongs to the total man.
- Man is both body and spirit.
- Man's attributes are finite, but real reflections of God's.

GOD	MAN
Sovereignty	Will
Righteousness / Justice	Conscience
Love	Personality
Omniscience	Intelligence
Omnipotence	Power
Immutability	Mutability
Eternality	Immortality

MAN'S CHARACTERISTICS
ARE REAL REFLECTIONS
OF GOD'S CHARACTERISTICS,
THOUGH FINITE.

2 WHAT IS MAN'S PURPOSE? THE WORLD MANDATE GENESIS 1:28

"Then God blessed them, and God said to them, 'Be fruitful and multiply; fill the earth and subdue it; have dominion over ...'" (NKJV)

God's command contains five verbs:

Be fruitful	Multiply	Fill	Subdue	Have dominion
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The summary reduces these to three:

BE FRUITFUL · SUBDUE · RULE

- A mandate is formal authorization from a superior to a subordinate.
- God commissioned man and woman as His viceroys—representative rulers under the High King.

SUBDUE

Bring something under control by conquest, then keep it under control through diligent maintenance.

RULE

Make authoritative decisions concerning the use, deployment, and future of a person or asset.

RULING AND DECISION-MAKING ARE INSEPARABLE.

Man is not merely capable of ruling.
God has given him authority to rule.

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3 WHAT IS MAN'S DOMAIN? THE EARTH — HIS REALM

- Adam began in the bounded territory of Eden.
- His domain then extended outward toward the whole world.
- God's first commands directed man downward and outward toward the earth and nature.

DOWNWARD AND OUTWARD

Toward the earth and nature.

WHY THE EARTH IS HIS DOMAIN?

Knowledge of nature leads to knowledge of God.

The created world reveals God's eternal power and divine nature.

Psalms 19:1

Romans 1:19–20

Nature contains treasures to discover.

There are riches and resources to be found through diligent exploration and work.

Proverbs 25:2

Matthew 7:7–8

The earthly realm is a proving ground.

Man is tested in his faithfulness with what is entrusted to him.

Matthew 24:45–51

25:14–30



The earth is not an escape from God, but a realm to be ruled for His glory.

4 WHAT IS MAN'S RESPONSIBILITY? MAKE HIS REALM FRUITFUL

- Every man receives his own portion of God's world and his own part of the Mandate.
- His domain includes everything God has made him responsible for and for which he will answer.

AREAS OF RESPONSIBILITY



Body



Soul



Time



Possessions



Money



Relationships



Talents



Words



Actions



Thoughts

- God supplies the starting capital—body, intellect, talents, family, heritage and opportunities.
- Some receive much. Some receive little.
- **All are accountable for what they are given.**

5 WHO DOES MAN ANSWER TO? GOD

- Man possesses genuine authority, but never autonomy.
- God placed a loyalty test within Adam's domain.
- The ruler himself remained under the rule of the Overlord.
- Every man will finally answer to the God who created and commissioned him.

2 Corinthians 5:10
1 Corinthians 10:31

